

Current Affairs — Daily Class Notes

Session Date: 27 August 2026 | Note: Class was held a day before Raksha Bandhan

Thought of the Day

Never give up — your next attempt could be the one that leads to success. Words like 'frustration' and 'depression' lose their grip when you carry genuine self-belief and the conviction that a task will get done. Self-motivation, not motivational videos, is what actually drives results.

1. Nepal Floods — Bhote Koshi River Disaster

A sudden and massive surge of water hit the Rasuwa district of Nepal, even though rainfall in the area was not heavy enough to explain the scale of destruction on its own. Over 1,000 people remain unaccounted for, including more than 250 foreign tourists and over 100 Indian tourists. The actual number of missing persons is feared to be higher than official figures.

Likely Cause

Experts suspect a glacial lake outburst / sudden glacier melt in Tibet, at the origin of the Bhote Koshi river. Rising temperatures in the region may have triggered rapid ice melt, sending a huge volume of water rushing downstream and destroying hydropower projects and dams along the way.

About the Bhote Koshi River

- Origin: Tibet, flows through the Himalayan region into Nepal.
- Known as 'Poiqu' in Tibet.
- Its own tributary is the Lande River.
- Forms a trans-boundary flow across China (Tibet), Nepal and India.
- Downstream, it joins the Koshi river system, which eventually joins the Gandak and then the Ganga.

Related Rivers

River	Alternate Name	Key Facts
Koshi River	Saptakoshi	~724 km long; a major tributary of the Ganga; known for frequently changing course (meandering), causing floods in Bihar.
Gandak River	Narayani	A tributary of the Ganga, originates in Nepal/Himalayas.
Bhote Koshi River	Poiqu (in Tibet)	Origin in Tibet; tributary is the Lande River; site of the 2026 flood disaster.

Impact on India

Water flowing downstream from Nepal is expected to affect India's border districts in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh, including Sitamarhi, West Champaran, Madhubani and Kishanganj, since these districts lie close to the Nepal border. About 105 Indians are reported missing.

India's Response

- PM Narendra Modi assured India's full support and assistance to Nepal.
- The NDRF (National Disaster Response Force) has been deployed to assist in rescue operations.
- India shares a border of about 1,700+ km with Nepal (context fact for border districts).

Quick Facts: Nepal

Type of country	Land-locked country
Capital	Kathmandu
India–Nepal joint military exercise	Surya Kiran
Prime Minister of Nepal	Referenced in class as 'Balen Shah' — please verify current officeholder before an exam.

Quick Revision — Topic 1

- Bhote Koshi river originates in Tibet and flows into Nepal, then India.
- Disaster location: Rasuwa district, Nepal.
- Suspected cause: glacier/glacial lake outburst due to rising temperature.
- Koshi river length: ~724 km; known as the 'Sorrow of Bihar' for its shifting course.
- Gandak river = Narayani river.
- NDRF sent by India to assist Nepal.

2. Carbofuran Insecticide Banned in India

The Ministry of Agriculture, headed by Shivraj Singh Chouhan, has imposed a ban on the insecticide Carbofuran because of its harmful effects on both human health and the environment. The ban has been imposed using powers under the Insecticides Act, 1968.

How it harms the body

Carbofuran interferes with an enzyme in the human body called Acetylcholinesterase. When this enzyme is disrupted, it can paralyse body parts and affect the nervous and respiratory systems, along with causing bioaccumulation in the body.

Quick Revision — Topic 2

- Banned insecticide: Carbofuran.
- Reason: harmful to human health and environment.
- Legal basis: Insecticides Act, 1968.
- Enzyme affected: Acetylcholinesterase.
- Ministry involved: Ministry of Agriculture (Minister: Shivraj Singh Chouhan).

3. e-Shram Portal Completes 5 Years

The e-Shram registration portal, launched for workers in the unorganised sector (such as daily-wage labourers, painters, masons and other informal workers), has completed 5 years since its launch.

- Launched in: 2021, to register unorganised sector workers.
- Total registrations: about 31.89 crore as of August 2026.
- Registration is Aadhaar-based — benefits apply only to Aadhaar cardholders.
- Covers 15 central government schemes; state government schemes are not included.

Quick Revision — Topic 3

- e-Shram launched in 2021 for the unorganised sector.
- 5 years completed; ~31.89 crore registrations (Aug 2026).
- Aadhaar-based registration.
- Linked to 15 central schemes only.

4. Sports Current Affairs

- Wimbledon 2026 Men's Singles Title: Jannik Sinner.
- French Open 2026 Men's Singles Title: Alexander Zverev.
- Upcoming Grand Slam: US Open — the final Grand Slam of the tennis calendar year.

5. South China Sea — China's Artificial Island on Antelope Reef

Satellite images have revealed that China has developed a roughly 6 sq. km area on Antelope Reef, part of the Paracel Islands in the South China Sea, building what appears to be a port/airbase-like facility. Vietnam has strongly objected, asserting that the territory belongs to it.

Background

- China claims most of the South China Sea based on the 'Nine-Dash Line', drawn in 1947.
- Countries with claims/coastline in the South China Sea: Vietnam, Philippines, China, Indonesia, Malaysia, among others.
- The sea contains roughly 250 islands; major island groups include the Paracel Islands (known as 'Xisha' to China) and the Spratly Islands.
- The Paracel Islands were controlled by Vietnam until China replaced Vietnamese forces there in 1974.
- China has reportedly been working on developing Antelope Reef since 2017.

Quick Revision — Topic 5

- China's artificial development: Antelope Reef, Paracel Islands, South China Sea.
- China's claim line: 'Nine-Dash Line' (1947).
- Paracel Islands = 'Xisha' in Chinese; other major group = Spratly Islands.
- China replaced Vietnam's control of Paracel Islands in 1974.
- Country objecting to the new development: Vietnam.

6. Other Terms Covered in Class

Term	Meaning
Writ of Certiorari	A writ issued by a higher court to a lower court or tribunal, typically to quash its order or transfer a case for review.
Dependency Ratio	The ratio that increases when the non-working (dependent) population outweighs the working-age population in an economy.

MCQ Practice — Today's Current Affairs

Q1. The Bhote Koshi river, in the news for a recent flash flood disaster, originates in which region?

- (a) Nepal
 - (b) Tibet (China)
 - (c) Bihar, India
 - (d) Bhutan
- Answer: (b) Tibet (China)**

Q2. In which district of Nepal did the recent flash flood disaster occur?

- (a) Kathmandu
- (b) Rasuwa
- (c) Pokhara
- (d) Chitwan

Answer: (b) Rasuwa

Q3. The Koshi river is also known by which alternate name?

- (a) Narayani
- (b) Saptakoshi
- (c) Poiqu
- (d) Lande

Answer: (b) Saptakoshi

Q4. Approximately what is the length of the Koshi River?

- (a) 424 km
- (b) 524 km
- (c) 624 km
- (d) 724 km

Answer: (d) 724 km

Q5. The Gandak River is also known as:

- (a) Sorrow of Bihar
- (b) Narayani
- (c) Poiqu
- (d) Xisha

Answer: (b) Narayani

Q6. Which Indian agency has been deployed to assist Nepal in flood rescue operations?

- (a) BSF
- (b) NDRF
- (c) CISF
- (d) ITBP

Answer: (b) NDRF

Q7. Nepal's capital city is:

- (a) Pokhara
- (b) Lumbini
- (c) Kathmandu
- (d) Biratnagar

Answer: (c) Kathmandu

Q8. India–Nepal joint military exercise is called:

- (a) Sampriti
- (b) Surya Kiran
- (c) Yudh Abhyas
- (d) Hand-in-Hand

Answer: (b) Surya Kiran

Q9. Carbofuran, recently banned in India, is a type of:

- (a) Fungicide
- (b) Herbicide
- (c) Insecticide
- (d) Rodenticide

Answer: (c) Insecticide

Q10. Under which Act was Carbofuran banned in India?

- (a) Environment Protection Act, 1986
- (b) Insecticides Act, 1968
- (c) Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006
- (d) Pesticides Management Bill

Answer: (b) Insecticides Act, 1968

Q11. Carbofuran primarily affects which enzyme in the human body?

- (a) Amylase
- (b) Acetylcholinesterase
- (c) Lipase
- (d) Pepsin

Answer: (b) Acetylcholinesterase

Q12. The e-Shram portal was launched primarily for which category of workers?

- (a) Organised sector
- (b) Government employees
- (c) Unorganised sector
- (d) IT sector

Answer: (c) Unorganised sector

Q13. In which year was the e-Shram portal launched?

- (a) 2019
- (b) 2020
- (c) 2021
- (d) 2022

Answer: (c) 2021

Q14. e-Shram registration is linked to how many central government schemes?

- (a) 10
- (b) 12
- (c) 15
- (d) 20

Answer: (c) 15

Q15. Who won the Wimbledon 2026 Men's Singles title?

- (a) Carlos Alcaraz
- (b) Alexander Zverev
- (c) Jannik Sinner
- (d) Novak Djokovic

Answer: (c) Jannik Sinner

Q16. Who won the French Open 2026 Men's Singles title?

- (a) Jannik Sinner
- (b) Alexander Zverev
- (c) Rafael Nadal
- (d) Daniil Medvedev

Answer: (b) Alexander Zverev

Q17. China's 'Nine-Dash Line', used to claim most of the South China Sea, was drawn in which year?

- (a) 1937
- (b) 1947
- (c) 1957
- (d) 1974

Answer: (b) 1947

Q18. China recently developed an artificial island/facility on which reef?

- (a) Scarborough Shoal
- (b) Antelope Reef
- (c) Mischief Reef
- (d) Fiery Cross Reef

Answer: (b) Antelope Reef

Q19. Antelope Reef is part of which island group?

- (a) Spratly Islands
- (b) Paracel Islands
- (c) Pratas Islands
- (d) Natuna Islands

Answer: (b) Paracel Islands

Q20. Which country has strongly objected to China's development on Antelope Reef?

- (a) Philippines
- (b) Malaysia
- (c) Vietnam
- (d) Indonesia

Answer: (c) Vietnam

Q21. A writ issued by a higher court to a lower court/tribunal (often to quash its order) is called:

- (a) Mandamus
- (b) Certiorari
- (c) Habeas Corpus
- (d) Quo Warranto

Answer: (b) Certiorari

Q22. The ratio that rises when the non-working population outnumbers the working population is called the:

- (a) Sex Ratio
- (b) Literacy Ratio
- (c) Dependency Ratio
- (d) Fertility Ratio

Answer: (c) Dependency Ratio